Six math clues · answer key

How a Hand Works

Find the repeated step, then check the blank against its neighbors. Welcome a spoken explanation.

Math 1 · 20

15 + 5 = 20. Each hand adds 5 fingers.

Math 2 · 10

8 + 2 = 10. Each thumb adds 2 bones.

Math 3 · 60

50 + 10 = 60. Each pair of hands adds 10 fingertips.

Math 4 · 16

14 + 2 = 16. Each step adds 2 pulls.

Math 5 · 30

25 + 5 = 30. Each outline adds 5 lines.

Math 6 · 70

60 + 10 = 70. Each bundle adds 10 cords.

Six skip-counting patterns with steps of 2, 5, and 10. Story numbers are for counting practice.

Reading & writing · answer key

How a Hand Works

Reading · 1

The toy shows its strings; a real hand hides them inside.

Reading · 2

Three bones per finger, two in the thumb, 27 in one hand.

Reading · 3

A forearm muscle pulls a tendon; the tendon curls the finger.

Reading · 4

Finger joints fold mostly one way; the thumb base swings across.

Reading · 5

Finger-curling muscles sit in the forearm, so it moves too.

Reading · 6

Back tendons pull fingers straight; toys may use elastic.

Math · all

20, 10, 60, 16, 30, 70.

Screen-free

Bones keep fingers stiff; tendons pull; joints bend; back tendons open.

Gentle pulls only: no yanking strings or bending fingers backward. Toys differ; a paper-and-straw hand works too.

Offer dictation: let the child say a complete thought while you write it, then invite a picture or label.

Four looks at a hand

How a Hand Works

Quiz 1. What keeps a finger stiff?

Small bones in a row keep each finger firm.

Quiz 2. What pulls a finger closed?

A forearm muscle pulls a tendon, and the tendon pulls the finger bones.

Quiz 3. Where does a finger bend?

A finger bends at joints, where two bones meet.

Quiz 4. What opens a hand again?

Muscles only pull, so tendons on the back of the hand pull fingers straight.

Gentle pulls only: no yanking strings or bending fingers backward. Toys differ; a paper-and-straw hand works too.